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ThePieCraft CRM Market Evaluation & Product Roadmap

A practical benchmark of the current CRM against modern agency platforms, followed by a role-specific roadmap for administrators, employees and clients.

Prepared for ThePieCraft Marketing

Version 1.0 | Confidential | Internal use only



01. Executive evaluation

Where the CRM stands today and what that means commercially.

The CRM is a credible internal agency-management foundation, but it does not yet match the workflow depth of mature CRM, agency operations or reporting platforms.

Area	Score	Current position
Security and architecture	7.5/10	Strong tenant, authentication, MFA, audit and rate-limiting foundation.
UI, desktop and Android	7/10	Modern dark interface and usable Android application; performance and accessibility polishing remains.
Employee management	6.5/10	Team, attendance, assignment and basic task workflows are useful.
Project management	6/10	Functional basics; limited resource planning, templates, dependencies and profitability.
Client portal	5.5/10	Projects, reports, invoices, documents and messages exist, but collaboration remains shallow.
Finance and invoicing	5/10	Useful invoice foundation; payments, retainers and true profitability remain incomplete.
Core CRM	4.5/10	Accounts, Contacts, Leads and Deals exist, but currently behave more like record lists than a full CRM.
Marketing reporting	4/10	Attribution and connector foundations exist, but not a complete automatic reporting product.
Automation	3.5/10	Technical foundations exist; a mature visual workflow builder does not.
Agency operations	3/10	Discovery, approvals, deployment, maintenance and change orders are largely setup-only.

5.5/10	7/10
Against established paid products	As a custom internal agency CRM

- Compared with spreadsheets, WhatsApp threads and disconnected tools, this CRM can provide a major operational improvement.
- Compared with HubSpot, Productive, Teamwork or AgencyAnalytics, several modules are broad but shallow.
- The right goal is an internal agency operating system, not a public multi-tenant SaaS product.
- Commercial SaaS billing, public onboarding and app-store compliance should not consume roadmap capacity now.

02. Market benchmark

The minimum workflow depth established products now provide.

Agency operations

Modern agency platforms combine client portals, billable time, workload planning, retainers, approval workflows and profitability. Teamwork positions these as core agency capabilities, while Productive emphasizes capacity planning, budget warnings and forward-looking profitability.

Sales CRM

A competitive sales CRM provides pipeline boards, stage ownership, activities, workflow automation, lead scoring and revenue forecasting. The current Accounts, Contacts and Deals modules establish the data foundation, but not yet this operational depth.

Marketing reporting

Agency reporting products increasingly provide large connector libraries, scheduled reporting, anomaly detection, forecasting, benchmarks and white-labelled client portals. ThePieCraft CRM has connector and attribution foundations, but production-grade OAuth, scheduled synchronization and cross-client monitoring remain incomplete.

Recommended position: a custom internal agency operating system combining sales, delivery, people, client collaboration, attribution and profitability.

The operating chain

LEAD	DEAL	PROJECT	WORK	APPROVAL	INVOICE	PAYMENT	PROFIT
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Every handoff should be connected, measurable and auditable. A won deal should be able to create the client, project, onboarding checklist, invoice schedule and initial assignments automatically.

03. Admin capabilities

Features that improve control, forecasting and agency profitability.

Client 360 workspace

- Contacts and decision-makers
- Deals, projects, campaigns and contracts
- Invoices, payments and documents
- Requests, communications and meeting notes
- Client health, lifetime value, renewals and profitability
- A complete activity timeline

Real deal pipeline

- Kanban stages and custom pipelines
- Deal owner, close date, probability and weighted revenue
- Calls, meetings, next actions and reminders
- Stale-deal detection and loss reasons
- Proposal generation and deal-to-project conversion
- Monthly revenue forecast

Agency command centre

- Revenue, cash collection and pipeline forecast
- Project health and deadline risk
- Workload, capacity and billable utilization
- Accounts with abnormal advertising spend
- Client profitability and scope creep
- Approvals, requests and invoices needing attention

Profitability engine

- Employee cost and billable rates
- Billable and non-billable time
- Vendor, freelancer and delivery costs
- Retainer utilization and unbilled work
- Margin by project, client, service and team
- Budget-overrun and overservicing alerts

04. Employee capabilities

A focused daily workspace that reduces coordination overhead.

My Day

- Today and overdue tasks in priority order
- Meetings, reminders and punch-in status
- Start/stop timer with billable and non-billable classification
- Approvals, client requests and files awaiting delivery
- Blocked work with escalation to a project manager
- Weekly capacity and workload view
- Proof-of-work submission and end-of-day summary

Delivery quality

- Service-specific project templates and recurring checklists
- Clear task acceptance criteria, dependencies and required assets
- SOP links and reusable campaign launch checklists
- Review and approval stages before client delivery
- Versioned deliverables with structured feedback
- Skills and availability-aware task assignment

Healthy management

- Admin sees capacity, deadlines, blockers and billable utilization - not invasive employee surveillance.
- Employees see why a task matters, who is waiting on it and what completion requires.
- Workload alerts should prevent double-booking and burnout before schedules fail.

The employee experience should answer one question immediately: What is the most important useful work I should complete next?

05. Client capabilities

A portal that reduces status calls and accelerates decisions.

Requests and collaboration

- Submit requests with urgency and required date
- Comment on deliverables and provide revision feedback
- Track request ownership, status and expected delivery
- See exactly what the agency is waiting for from the client

Approvals

- Approve or reject creatives, budgets, sitemaps and designs
- Annotate images, PDFs and web pages
- Require a reason for rejection
- Keep a time-stamped approval and revision history

Commercial visibility

- View proposals, invoices and payment status
- Approve change orders digitally
- See retainer usage and included deliverables
- Access contracts and recurring service details

Reporting

- Live and scheduled performance reports
- Targets versus actual results
- Plain-language summary of what changed
- Work completed, next-period plan and recommendations
- Comment and acknowledge reports inside the portal

Client visibility should be selective: enough to build confidence, without exposing internal costs, private discussions or unrelated work.

06. Marketing intelligence

Turn campaign data into operational and financial decisions.

Production-grade connectors

- OAuth connection flows instead of manually pasted credentials
- Account/property selection and per-client mapping
- Scheduled background synchronization with retry
- Sync history, last-success status and expired-token warnings
- Normalized daily metric snapshots across Google Ads, Meta Ads, GA4 and Search Console
- Later: Google Business Profile, LinkedIn Ads, Microsoft Ads and call tracking

Full attribution and lead-quality feedback

- Capture UTM values, gclid, gbraid, wbraid, fbclid, referrer and landing page
- Preserve first-touch and last-touch source through the sales lifecycle
- Connect lead status, qualification, won revenue and profit to campaign/ad/keyword/creative
- Upload qualified and won outcomes to Google Enhanced/Offline Conversions and Meta CAPI
- Optimize advertising for qualified business instead of inexpensive low-quality leads

Cross-client command centre

- Budget pacing and projected month-end spend
- Conversion, CPL and CPA anomalies
- Creative fatigue and tracking failures
- Disapproved ads and campaigns without conversions
- Account-level targets, profitability and reports awaiting review

Potential differentiator: connect the original campaign to the lead, delivered work, collected revenue and final client margin.

07. Website delivery operating system

A structured workflow from discovery through maintenance.

Stage	Workflow	CRM responsibility
1	Discovery	Questionnaire, goals, audience, competitor references, required integrations and ownership.
2	Planning	Sitemap, content inventory, milestones, responsibilities, assumptions and risks.
3	Design	Wireframes, visual design, page-level review, annotations and formal approval.
4	Build	Page progress, content status, staging environment, dependencies and QA tasks.
5	Launch	Responsive, SEO, analytics, forms, cookie, security, DNS, SSL and deployment checklists.
6	Care	Backups, uptime, maintenance, warranty period, recurring checks and change requests.

Scope-creep protection

- Record included deliverables and revision limits
- Identify an out-of-scope request and estimate additional hours/cost
- Require internal approval followed by client acceptance
- Create a change order and associated invoice line item
- Preserve an audit trail of the approved scope and commercial effect

08. Finance, automation and notifications

Support profitability without trying to rebuild every specialist product.

India-specific finance

- GSTIN and billing addresses; CGST, SGST and IGST; SAC codes
- TDS tracking, credit notes and recurring retainer invoices
- Razorpay and UPI payment links with reconciliation
- Vendor expenses, outstanding ageing and tax-ready exports
- Integrate with accounting software instead of becoming a full accounting suite

Automation builder

- Trigger: deal won, task overdue, invoice unpaid, request submitted or approval completed
- Conditions based on client, service, owner, value, priority or status
- Actions: create work, assign owner, notify user, request approval, generate invoice or call webhook
- Run history, failure details, retry and audit trail
- Reusable recipes for onboarding, reporting, renewals and website launches

Notification centre

- In-app, email, WhatsApp templates and Android push notifications
- Reminders for tasks, approvals, overdue invoices, budget anomalies and client requests
- Per-user delivery preferences, quiet hours and digest frequency
- A delivery log showing queued, sent, delivered and failed messages

09. Recommended implementation order

Build depth in the most valuable operating loop before expanding breadth.

Priority	Objective	Key deliverables
P0	Trustworthy operations	Role-based E2E tests; SMTP; private storage and scanning; backups and restore drill; error and job monitoring; mobile performance; release signing.
P1	Daily operational value	Client 360; My Day; time tracking; workload; project templates; approvals; proof-of-work; change orders.
P2	Money and management	Retainers; cost and billable rates; budget burn; utilization; profitability; collections; pipeline forecasting; client health.
P3	Marketing intelligence	OAuth connectors; scheduled sync; attribution; offline conversions; Meta CAPI; pacing; anomaly and fatigue alerts; reports.
P4	Automation and intelligence	Visual automation builder; custom fields; import and dedupe; API/webhooks; risk prediction; lead scoring; smart scheduling.

Priority 0 acceptance criteria

- Disposable admin, employee and client accounts can complete critical end-to-end flows automatically.
- Email, files, backups, jobs and production errors have observable success/failure states.
- The Android release uses a protected production signing key and can be updated safely.
- No critical role relationship relies on mock data or unverified manual assumptions.

Priority 1 success condition

An admin should be able to convert a won deal into assigned delivery work; an employee should see and complete it in My Day; a client should approve the output; and the CRM should preserve the complete history without using a spreadsheet or a WhatsApp thread as the system of record.

10. What not to build yet

Protect development capacity from expensive distractions.

- Public SaaS subscriptions, organization billing and self-service tenant onboarding
- Play Store or App Store publishing infrastructure
- A complete email-marketing product
- A social-media scheduling suite
- Payroll or full bookkeeping/accounting
- A generic website builder
- More disconnected AI chat screens
- Additional dashboard cards that do not lead to an actionable workflow

Use integration where a specialist system already performs the job well. Build deeply where ThePieCraft's agency workflow is unique.

Recommended product principle

Every new feature should either save team time, accelerate a client decision, protect delivery quality, improve cash collection, or expose profit and risk. Features that do none of these should not enter the near-term roadmap.

11. Strategic differentiation

The strongest market position available to this internal product.

Show which campaign generated the lead, which employee handled it, what work was delivered, how much time and ad spend it consumed, how much the client paid, and the final profit - all in one chain.

Why this is defensible

- Traditional CRMs focus on leads and deals but usually stop before agency delivery.
- Project tools track work but often lack deep marketing attribution.
- Reporting platforms display channel metrics but do not understand labor cost, scope or collections.
- Accounting tools see invoices and expenses but not campaign quality or client approval delays.
- A connected internal system can combine these views using ThePieCraft's own operating rules.

North-star outcomes

ADMIN	EMPLOYEE	CLIENT
Know what is profitable, at risk and awaiting a decision.	Know exactly what to do next and what completion means.	Know what is happening, what requires approval and what result was achieved.

12. Reference sources

Current product-market references used for the benchmark.

Teamwork - Agency project management

Client portals, billable time, resource allocation, retainers, proofing and profitability.

<https://www.teamwork.com/teams/agencies/>

Productive - Agency management software

Capacity planning, budget warnings, utilization and financial forecasting.

<https://productive.io/industries/agency-management-software/>

HubSpot - Sales tracking software

Pipeline visibility, lead scoring, workflow automation and revenue forecasting.

<https://www.hubspot.com/products/sales/sales-tracking>

AgencyAnalytics - Client reporting

Marketing connectors, automated reporting, alerts, anomaly detection and client portals.

<https://agencyanalytics.com/>

Assessment note

Scores are product-maturity estimates based on the reviewed ThePieCraft CRM codebase, deployed-system checks and comparison with current official competitor feature descriptions. They are intended for internal prioritization, not as a penetration-test result, financial valuation or guarantee that every authenticated production workflow has completed role-based acceptance testing.

Next review point: after Priority 0 and Priority 1 are complete, repeat the scorecard using production-like admin, employee and client workflows.